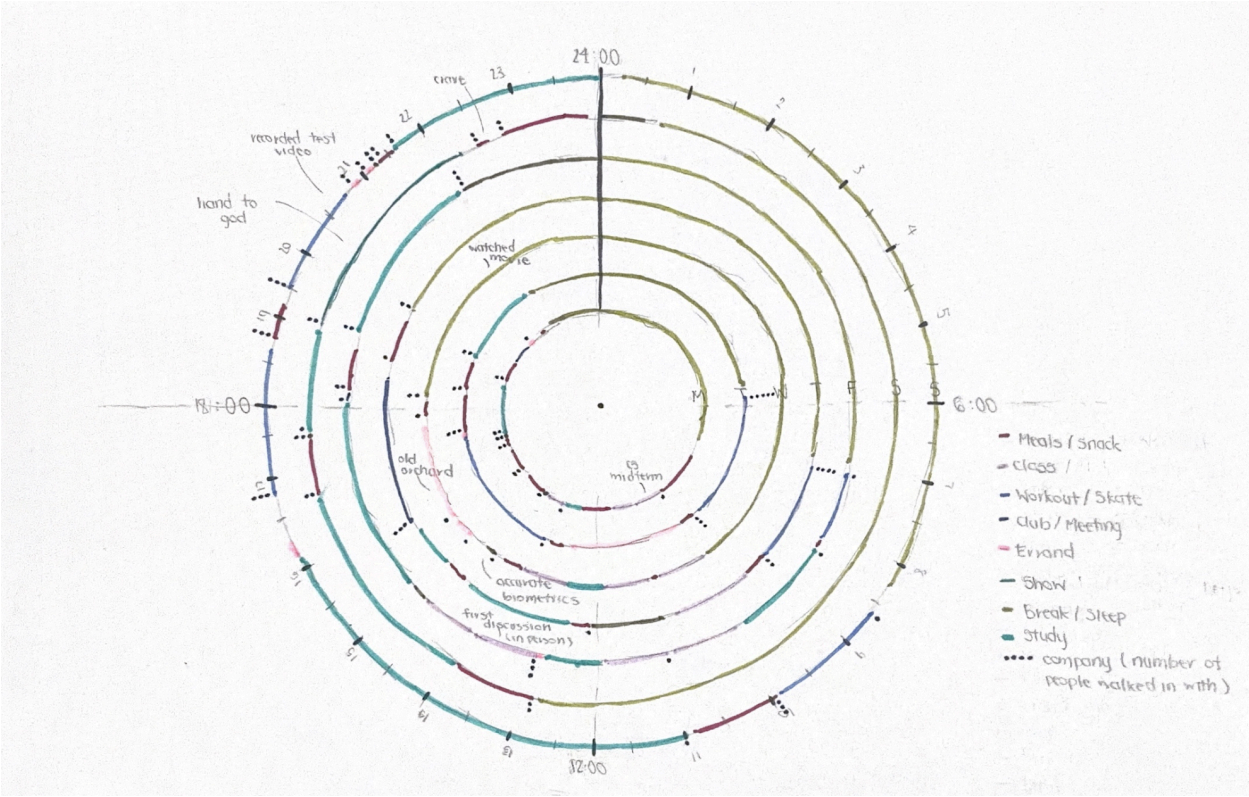
My own dear data:



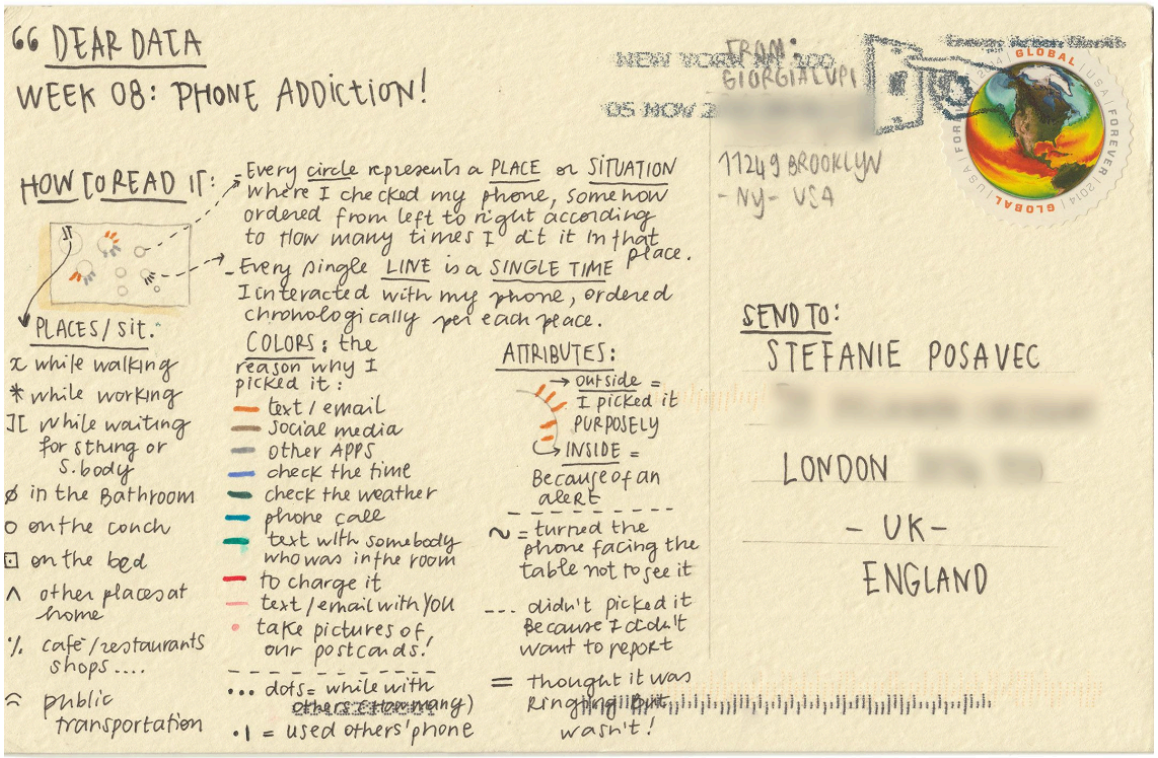
For this problem set, we chose to track data about our daily building activities. As such, the main tracking we did was which buildings we went to on a given day. The main components that went along with this were time entered/exited (duration), and other general building related information (crowd, company, northwestern affiliation).

For the visualization, I chose to utilize concentric circles to display a graph not dissimilar to a clock. Each line represents a different building I entered, with the length of the line denoted the duration spent inside each building. I mapped color to the purpose of entering the building. While some of the buildings I entered I achieved multiple different tasks in, I chose to stick with the initial task as the one representing the color. While I tracked the data of crowd and northwestern affiliation, as well as building name, I thought that adding it to my drawing would overcrowd the plot and detract from the overall meaning. As such, only purpose, duration, and company are mapped. The company is mapped in a similar way to the Dear Data Week 8 postcard I recreate below, with dots representing each individual that walked into the building with me. In my data set there were even more specific categories, especially for errands (ie. Laundry, Van Pickup, etc…). However, for the visualization, I chose to cluster and group them. I appreciate how you can tell immediately by looking at the graph, where I spent the most time over the course of the week. With the green for sleep and the blue for studying being the most prominent. Additionally, perusing through my data, I highlighted a few key buildings/purposes with direct labels that I thought I could draw attention to.

Dear Data recreation.

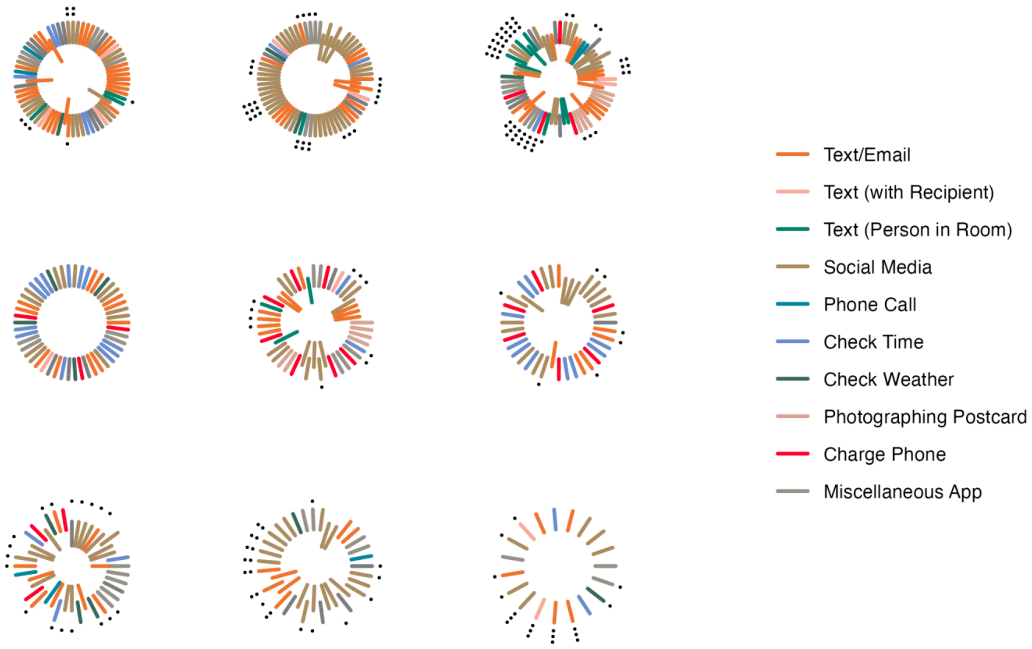
I decided to recreate week 8's visualization:





This week tackled the amount of times they checked their phone throughout the week. Each major location represented a circle, with tick marks representing each time checking the phone. Distinctions were made using colors, shapes, and sizes, to represent purposes.

My recreation using ggplot:



From Left to Right: Walking, Working, Waiting, Bathroom, Couch, Bed, Home, Cafe, Transit.
Inside ticks: Due to Notification. Outside ticks: On Purpose. Number of dots: Company.

While I did not keep the entire plot exactly representative of the original drawing, I attempted to keep the main aspects similar. For example, the circular rings with tick marks are as identical to the original as I could get. I took creative liberties with the placement/size of the circles as well as where the legend was placed, but other than that the graph represents the same data. For the data, I took each line in the original drawing and inputted the meaning into a google sheet which I then exported into a csv to read. In R, I arranged the data into angles, based on location in the dataset. As such, each tick in the ring had its own angle. I then used this angle to construct rings, with start and end radii. For each additional element, I altered the radius accordingly (inner ticks had an earlier start value). The color of the tick was mapped to reason. The dots were created with three more rings around the circle, mapped to the number of individuals in the creator's company at the time of phone usage. One thing I thought could be better about the original were the color choices. There were many ticks of very similar colors, such as Text (Person in Room), Phone Call, and Check Weather. For the recreation I used the colors given, but if I were to attempt this myself, I would most definitely change the colors to be more readable. I also chose to omit the random fancy symbols that signified location, instead opting for a written label at the bottom. Overall, the gist of the graph remains the same, although

I made some stylistic choices. While most unreadable without the legend, I do enjoy the nine rings alone without additional information. The minimalistic nature, while unclear in meaning, strikes me as intriguing:

